

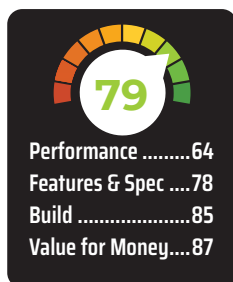
ASUS ROG Zephyrus G16 (2024)

Balancing performance and portability



A SUS ROG is a brand that normally screams gaming, but one look at the new 2024 ASUS ROG Zephyrus G16 will tell you that it's a bit of a departure from ASUS's conventional gaming aesthetic. For that matter, it's a departure from previous Zephyrus models as well. With the new Zephyrus G16, ASUS is hoping to target the larger non-gaming audience, and hoping to pull in not just the gamers, but also content creators who are looking for powerful and compact laptops.

The model we're reviewing, which is the ASUS ROG Zephyrus G16 GU605MY to be exact, is the most powerful configuration of the Zephyrus G16 that ASUS offers, featuring the latest top-of-the-line hardware from Intel and NVIDIA. We're talking an Intel Core Ultra 9 185H processor paired with an NVIDIA RTX 4090 Laptop GPU. You also have Intel Core Ultra 7 variants, with GPU options going down to the RTX 4050. Despite the powerful hardware on board, the Zephyrus G16



is surprisingly thin and light. Read on to find out whether or not that affects how well the ASUS ROG Zephyrus G16 performs.

BUILD AND DESIGN

There's no denying that the ROG Zephyrus G16 feels incredibly premium.

The unibody aluminium chassis offers fantastic stability. There's no flexing or creaking anywhere; even the keyboard doesn't depress under pressure.

If you're familiar with previous iterations of the Zephyrus, you'll also notice that ASUS has done away with the dot-matrix display on the lid. Instead, you now have a single thin light strip running across the lid diagonally. This strip, which ASUS calls Slash Lighting, consists of 28 mini LEDs and 7 different zones. The Slash Lighting can be customised, and can even be programmed to light up when you want it to, like with notifications for example. We're pretty on the fence about Slash Lighting, but it's subjective. You can also turn it off entirely if you want. The Slash Lighting and

the keyboard are the only two elements of the ROG Zephyrus G16 that are lit up, so it draws comparatively less attention than previous iterations of the Zephyrus.

The ROG Zephyrus G16 also features a new clamshell design which is supposed to help prevent hot air from blowing onto the display. However, this impedes the laptop's maximum opening angle, which is now limited to 135 degrees. For context, previous Zephyrus models could be opened to 180 degrees.

ASUS has managed to pack some serious hardware into what is one of the slimmest and lightest laptop models we've tested to date, within the segment of course. Looking at the laptop it's easy to immediately draw comparisons to the likes of the MacBook Pro and even the Razer Blade 16. This variant of the ROG Zephyrus G16 weighs 1.95 kg and is 17.4 mm thick.

KEYBOARD AND TOUCHPAD

The Zephyrus G16 comes with a backlit keyboard and no numpad. While there's ample space between keys, the single-line Enter Key and the tiny arrow keys can take some getting used to. Once you get used to the layout, the experience is very comfortable. The 1.7 mm travel distance feels good to type on and the keys are also silent.

The touchpad on this laptop is massive. At 15 x 9.9 cm it's way larger than any of the previous Zephyrus touchpads. The surface is smooth and it has a nice click as well. It feels as premium as the rest of the laptop.

I/O PORTS

Because of the clamshell design we mentioned earlier, there's no room on the rear for ports. Another departure from previous iterations of the Zephyrus. This means that all ports are on the laptop's left or right side. On the left side of the laptop, you have the power supply port, an HDMI 2.1 port, a Thunderbolt 4 USB-C port, a USB-A 3.2 Gen 2 port, and a 3.5 mm audio combo jack. On the right side, you have an SD